

— WORK AND MEANING

Purpose Crafting

You cannot always change the job. Some tasks are just part of the deal and some people are just part of the room. But you can change the story you tell yourself about it, and that changes how it feels.

Purpose crafting means hunting for the meaning that is already sitting inside your work, even in the dull or difficult bits. You do not swap tasks. You shift where you are looking from.

There are three ways in. Pick the one that feels most like you, or do all three.

LENS ONE**Zoom out**

See how your work connects to something bigger than you: the people it helps, the thing it keeps running, the ripple it makes.

Example. A customer service rep stops seeing "handling complaints" and starts seeing "turning bad days into better ones". Same calls, different job.

LENS TWO**Zoom in**

Pick out the parts of your job you actually enjoy, even if they are small, and let those carry the rest of the day.

Example. A marketing manager who loves creative problem-solving leans into new campaign ideas, and uses that spark to get through the paperwork.

LENS THREE**Connect it**

Link what you care about, your strengths, values and hobbies, to what you do at work. Find the thread.

Example. A sales rep who does stand-up comedy treats a presentation as a stage: read the room, hold attention, land the punchline, close.

Based on job-crafting research (Berg, Dutton and Wrzesniewski, 2013), reworked as a coaching exercise.

Name _____

Date _____

STEP 1 **Zoom out**

Start by finding the bigger meaning in the work you do. Use these to get unstuck:

- 01** Who benefits from your work, directly or indirectly, and how?
- 02** If your job vanished tomorrow, what would be missed, and by whom?
- 03** How does your work feed the bigger goal of your team or business?
- 04** What good ripples does it send out to colleagues, customers, or the wider community?

How is your work making a bigger difference than you give it credit for?

Example. "I am an accountant. I help my colleagues provide for their families by keeping the company running smoothly, and I help other businesses build things that help society. Without accounting, modern commerce would not function. I also try to be a cheerful, supportive colleague, and I mentor newer people, which makes me feel useful."

STEP 2

Zoom in

Now pick out the bits of the job that light you up. Tasks, people, moments. If you are stuck, try these:

- 01 Which tasks do you actually look forward to in your workday?
- 02 When do you feel most energised, switched on, or "in the zone"?
- 03 Think of a recent win. What were you doing, and why did it feel so good?
- 04 What are you uniquely good at, and which skills do you enjoy using most?

What are the most enjoyable, meaningful parts of your job?

Example. "Being an accountant is much more than numbers to me. What I truly love is helping people through the maze of taxes. One-to-one guidance feels deeply satisfying, because I know my advice can change someone's business and, by extension, their life."

STEP 3

Connect it

Now link who you are to what you do. Use your strengths, what matters to you, and what you love outside work. If you have already done a self-discovery exercise, bring those answers here.

A strength of mine		How it shows up in my work
eg	Attention to detail	I notice small things other people miss, which cuts down mistakes.
1		
2		
3		

Something I value		How my work lets me live it
eg	Independence	I run client work at my own pace, and I can work remotely.
1		
2		
3		

Something I love outside work		What it gives my work
eg	Playing football	It has sharpened my teamwork and made me calmer under pressure.
1		
2		
3		

STEP 4

What changed?

You have looked at your work from three angles. Take a minute to notice what shifted.

Which of the three lenses made the biggest difference to how you feel about work, and why?

What is one small thing you will do differently at work this week because of this?

— IF IT STILL FEELS FLAT

Sometimes the story is not the problem, the job is. That is useful information too. If purpose crafting leaves you more sure you need a bigger change, that is exactly what we can work on together.